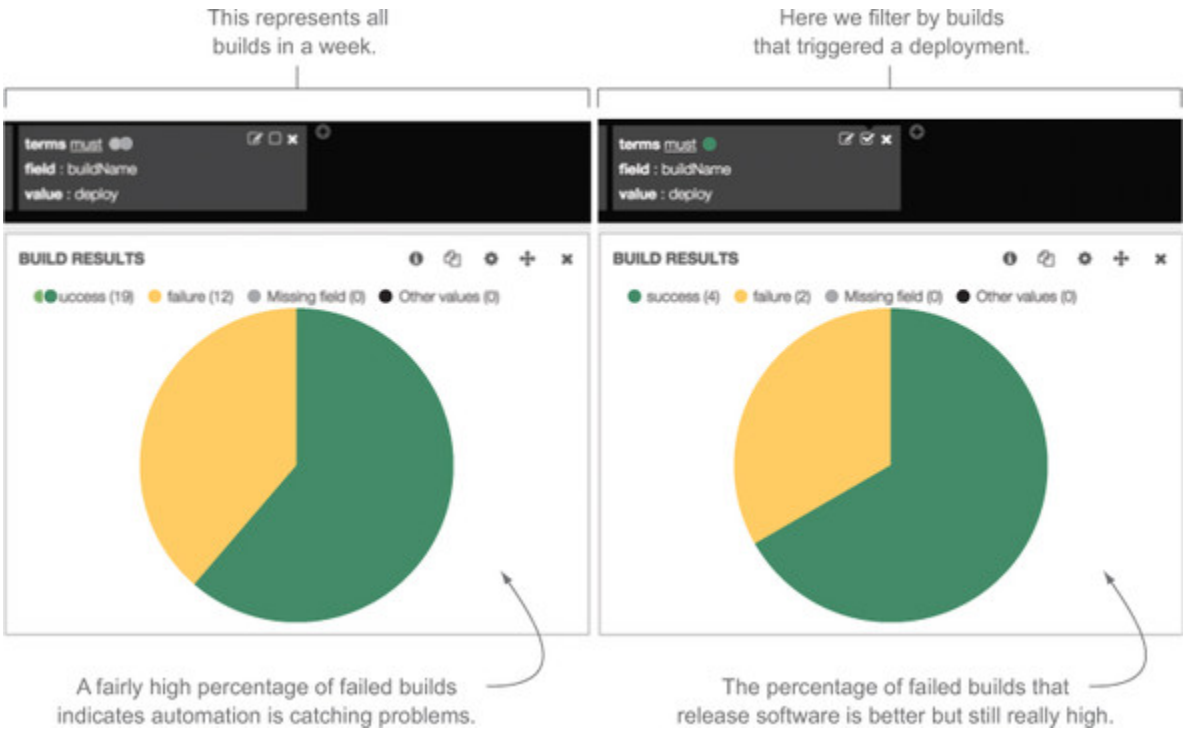


The team depicted in figure 5.14 is building 31 times a week and releasing software 6 times a week. Of their releases 33% fail, and of total builds 38.7% fail. Despite having a high failure rate for releases, the team still has four successful deployments a week, which is pretty good. Now imagine a team that releases software twice a month with a 33% failure rate; that would mean the team would sometimes go for an entire month without releasing anything to their customers. For teams that release daily, the tolerance for failure ends up being much higher due to the higher release frequency. Teams that release every two weeks usually are expected to have a successful deployment rate of close to 100%, a much harder target to hit.

5.5. Case study: measuring benefits of process change through CI data

We ended chapter 4 with a happy team that made some measurements, reacted to them, and had great results. They moved to the pull request workflow on their development team and moved quality into the development process. They were able to measure some key metrics that were being generated from their development process to track progress and